
From the opening anchor to independent decisions

ORIGINAL TRAINING CONTINUATIONS

These ten laboratories were extended with local Stockfish analysis. They are not historical master games. They illustrate one legal continuation to roughly moves 20-24, including White's replies.

START WITH BLACK TO MOVE

Each laboratory starts at a Black decision after White has played the next move beyond the opening study line. Cover the following pages and write a candidate move, its purpose and White's best reply.

COMPARE THE ALTERNATIVES

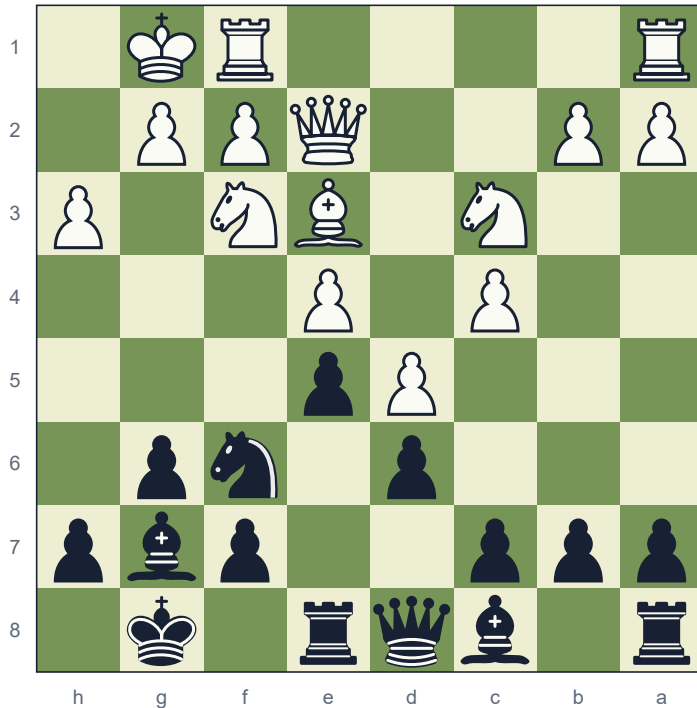
The decision page gives two searched candidates and short principal variations. Those variations are calculation samples, not forced scripts. Compare what each move changes rather than trying to memorize all of them.

PLAY THE POSITION

Use Middlegame_Laboratory.pgn to replay or set up the position. Play it with both colors. A move different from the sample is not automatically a mistake; analyze the first new decision after the game.

Classical gateway / start

LAB 02-02 | Begin at 11... | Black to move



Black to move

YOUR INTENDED PLAN

Calculate Bxd4 and Nxd4 before choosing a recapture. Finish development while using the active knight and the central files.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White develops behind a space advantage. Re1, Be3 and exchanges on e5 can stop Black from getting a routine kingside race.

BEFORE TURNING THE PAGE

Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate the strongest forcing reply and identify the piece or pawn that changes its role. If the position is in check, begin with legal replies to that check.

STRUCTURE CHECKPOINT

The defining choice is whether d4 meets e5 by advancing, exchanging, or remaining in contact. Only the advance creates the familiar locked chain.

Classical gateway / compare decisions

11... NH5 VERSUS H6

Vacates f6 for the f-pawn and influences f4. Keep a safe route if White attacks the knight.

Sample A: 11... Nh5 12. a4 a5 13. Ra3 b6 14. Nb5

Sample B: 11... h6 12. b4 a5 13. a3 Nh5 14. c5

13... B6 VERSUS BD7

Improves the pawn on b6. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 13... b6 14. Bg5 Bf6 15. Bd2 Bg7 16. Rfe1

Sample B: 13... Bd7 14. Ra3

15... BF6 VERSUS QC8

Improves the bishop on f6. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 15... Bf6 16. Be3 Nf4 17. Qd1 Bg7 18. Kh2

Sample B: 15... Qc8

17... BG7 VERSUS RF8

Improves the bishop on g7. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

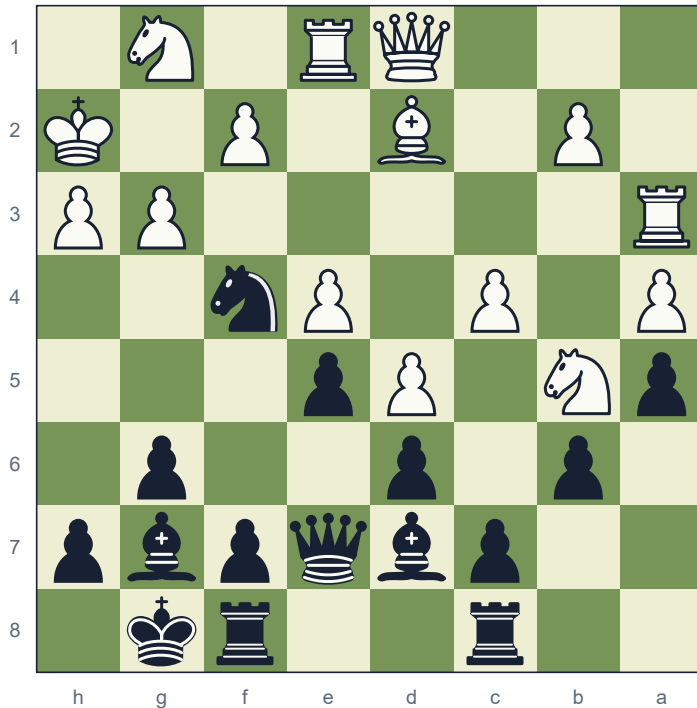
Sample A: 17... Bg7 18. Kh2 Rf8 19. Qc1 Ne2 20. Qc2

Sample B: 17... Rf8 18. Kh2 Bg7 19. Qc1 Ne2 20. Qa1

The alternatives were searched at 500,000 nodes per analysis with MultiPV 2. A finite search is a comparison aid, not proof of a unique best move.

Classical gateway / sample play

11... Nh5 12. a4 a5 13. Nb5 b6 14. Ra3 Bd7 15. Bg5 Bf6 16. Bd2 Nf4 17. Qd1 Bg7 18. Kh2 Rf8 19. Ng1 Qe7 20. Re1 Rac8 21. g3



Black to move | sample endpoint

EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pieces were exchanged? Did a pawn contact disappear? Is the original plan still useful, or has an open file or king-safety issue become more urgent?

YOUR NEXT DECISION

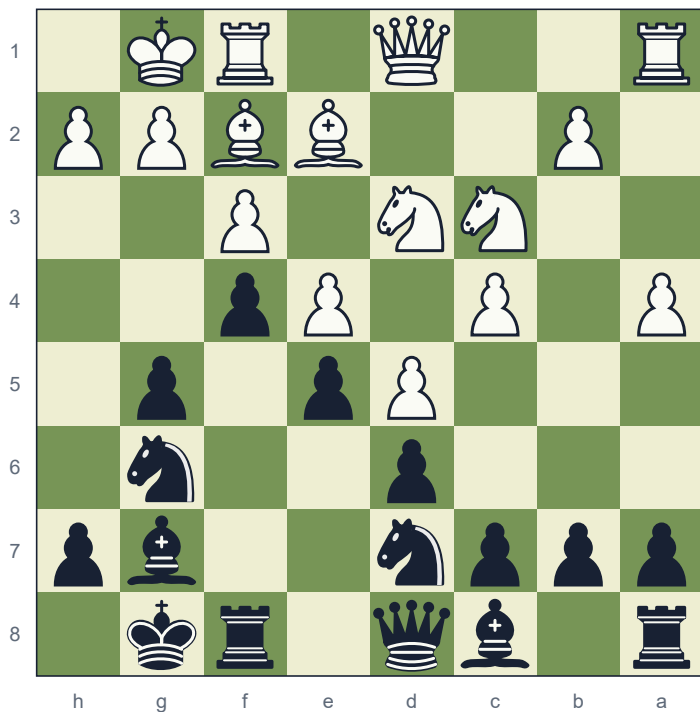
Name two candidate moves for the side to move. Calculate the forcing reply to each, then explain Black's longer-term job from the resulting position.

REPLAY DRILL

Return to the start position and play against a partner or a program. Record your first divergence from the sample and one defensive resource you missed. Review the decision before asking the engine for a numerical evaluation.

Mar del Plata / start

LAB 03-01 | Begin at 14... | Black to move



Black to move

YOUR INTENDED PLAN

Coordinate ...Nf6, ...h5 and queen or rook access before sacrificing. White will often play c5, so estimate whether you can tolerate a queenside file opening.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White normally expands with c5, opens c-files, and uses the e1 knight to support the queenside or defend. White can also challenge your attack with g4.

BEFORE TURNING THE PAGE

Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate the strongest forcing reply and identify the piece or pawn that changes its role. If the position is in check, begin with legal replies to that check.

STRUCTURE CHECKPOINT

White has d5 and e4 against d6 and e5. After ...f4 the center and kingside gain a second chain, giving Black space but fixing targets.

Mar del Plata / compare decisions

14... NF6 VERSUS KH8

Improves the knight on f6. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 14... Nf6 15. a5

Sample B: 14... Kh8 15. a5 Nf6 16. c5 h5 17. cxd6

16... BXA6 VERSUS B6

The pawn captures on a6. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan.

Sample A: 16... bxa6 17. Nb4 g4 18. Nc6 Qd7 19. c5

Sample B: 16... b6

18... QD7 VERSUS QE8

Improves the queen on d7. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 18... Qd7 19. c5 g3 20. Be1 h4 21. h3

Sample B: 18... Qe8 19. c5

20... H4 VERSUS NH7

Improves the pawn on h4. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

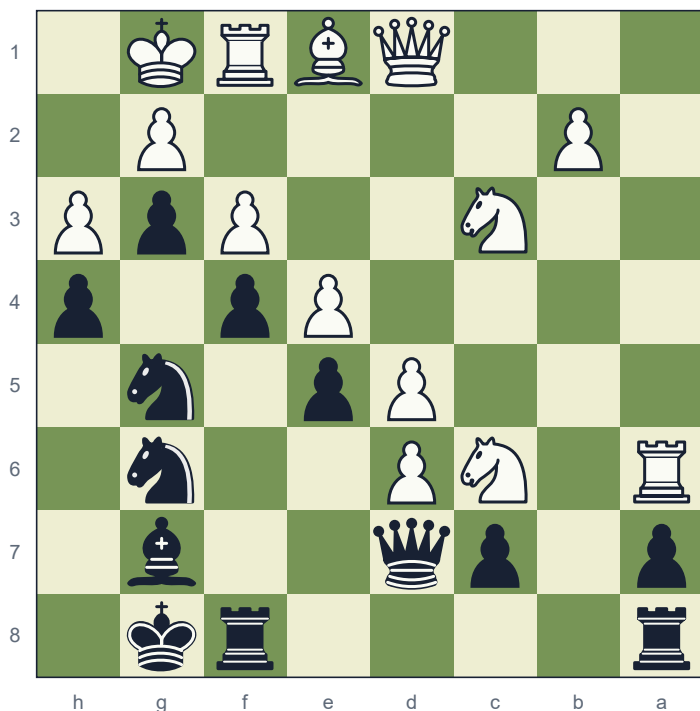
Sample A: 20... h4 21. h3 Nh7 22. Bxa6 Bxa6 23. Rxa6

Sample B: 20... Nh7 21. hxg3

The alternatives were searched at 500,000 nodes per analysis with MultiPV 2. A finite search is a comparison aid, not proof of a unique best move.

Mar del Plata / sample play

14... Nf6 15. a5 h5 16. a6 bxa6 17. Nb4 g4 18. Nc6 Qd7 19. c5 g3 20. Be1 h4 21. h3 Nh7 22. Bxa6 Bxa6
23. Rxa6 Ng5 24. cxd6



Black to move | sample endpoint

EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pieces were exchanged? Did a pawn contact disappear? Is the original plan still useful, or has an open file or king-safety issue become more urgent?

YOUR NEXT DECISION

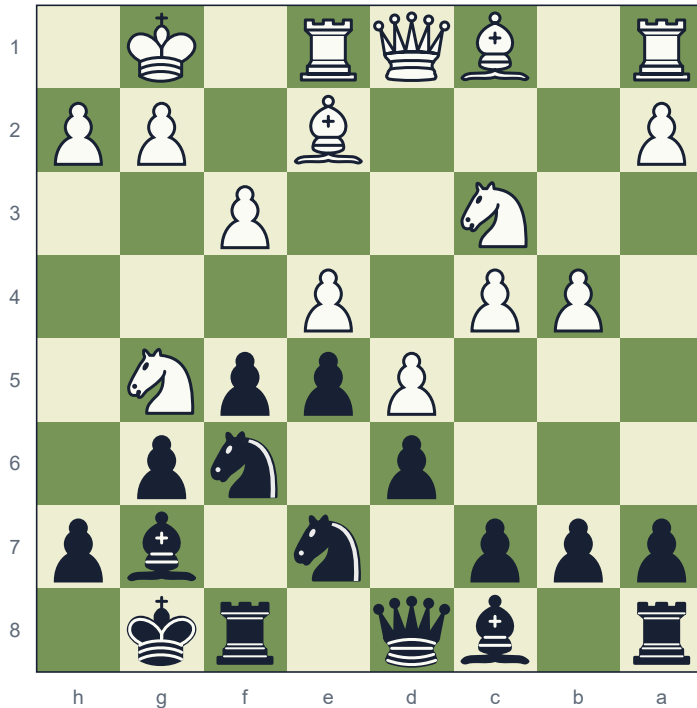
Name two candidate moves for the side to move. Calculate the forcing reply to each, then explain Black's longer-term job from the resulting position.

REPLAY DRILL

Return to the start position and play against a partner or a program. Record your first divergence from the sample and one defensive resource you missed. Review the decision before asking the engine for a numerical evaluation.

Bayonet Attack / start

LAB 04-01 | Begin at 12... | Black to move



Black to move

YOUR INTENDED PLAN

Develop ...h6 only if it improves the tactical position, and consider ...a5 to question b4. White may trade on e6 or advance c5.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White wants c5, exchanges on d6, and an initiative before your kingside attack develops. Re1 strengthens e4 and prepares Bf1.

BEFORE TURNING THE PAGE

Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate the strongest forcing reply and identify the piece or pawn that changes its role. If the position is in check, begin with legal replies to that check.

STRUCTURE CHECKPOINT

White gains queenside space with b4 and threatens c5. The e4 pawn can become tactically vulnerable after the knight reaches f4.

Bayonet Attack / compare decisions

12... KH8 VERSUS C6

Improves the king on h8. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 12... Kh8 13. a4 Nh5 14. c5 Nf4 15. Bc4

Sample B: 12... c6 13. Be3 Bh6 14. c5 f4 15. Bf2

14... NH5 VERSUS RE8

Vacates f6 for the f-pawn and influences f4. Keep a safe route if White attacks the knight.

Sample A: 14... Nh5 15. c5 Nf4 16. Bc4 fxe4 17. Rxe4

Sample B: 14... Re8

16... FXE4 VERSUS DXC5

The pawn captures on e4. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan.

Sample A: 16... fxe4 17. Rxe4 Nf5 18. Bxf4 exf4 19. Nd5

Sample B: 16... dxc5 17. bxc5

18... DXE4 VERSUS EXF4

The pawn captures on e4. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan.

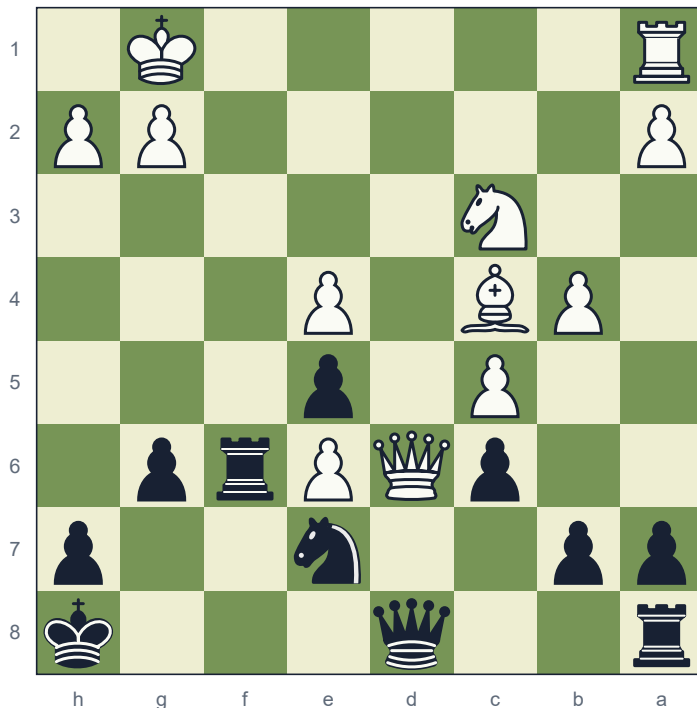
Sample A: 18... dxe4 19. Bg5 Bf6 20. Bxf6+ Rxf6 21. Nxe4

Sample B: 18... exf4 19. Nxd5 Nxd5 20. Bxd5 Qe7 21. c6

The alternatives were searched at 500,000 nodes per analysis with MultiPV 2. A finite search is a comparison aid, not proof of a unique best move.

Bayonet Attack / sample play

12... Kh8 13. Ne6 Bxe6 14. dxe6 Nh5 15. c5 Nf4 16. Bc4 fxe4 17. Rxe4 d5 18. Bxf4 dxe4 19. Bg5 Bf6
20. Bxf6+ Rxf6 21. fxe4 c6 22. Qd6



Black to move | sample endpoint

EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pieces were exchanged? Did a pawn contact disappear? Is the original plan still useful, or has an open file or king-safety issue become more urgent?

YOUR NEXT DECISION

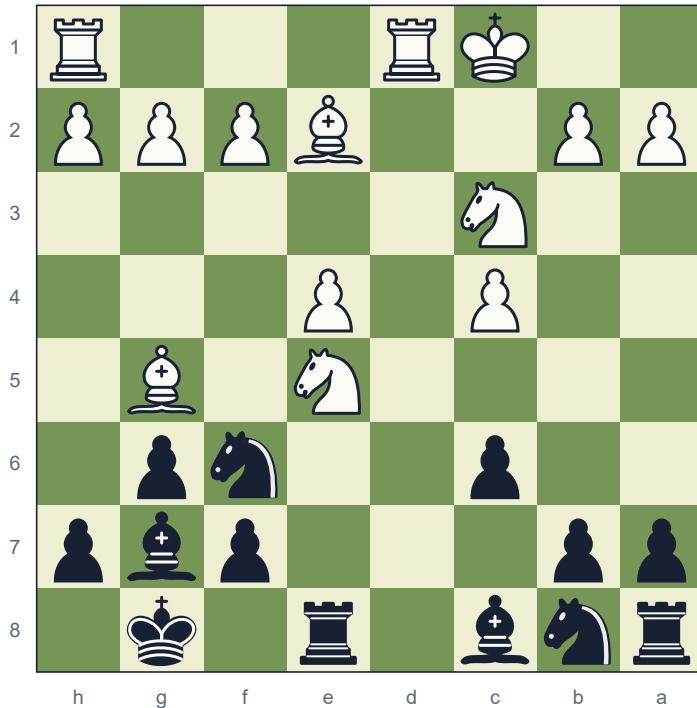
Name two candidate moves for the side to move. Calculate the forcing reply to each, then explain Black's longer-term job from the resulting position.

REPLAY DRILL

Return to the start position and play against a partner or a program. Record your first divergence from the sample and one defensive resource you missed. Review the decision before asking the engine for a numerical evaluation.

Exchange Variation / start

LAB 06-01 | Begin at 11... | Black to move



Black to move

YOUR INTENDED PLAN

Develop the b8 knight and the c8 bishop, then challenge the d-file. Watch for a knight reaching d5.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White may exchange queens, develop Bg5, or enter a quiet maneuvering game. White retains the first-move initiative but has given up the d5 wedge.

BEFORE TURNING THE PAGE

Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate the strongest forcing reply and identify the piece or pawn that changes its role. If the position is in check, begin with legal replies to that check.

STRUCTURE CHECKPOINT

The d-file opens, with White's e4 pawn facing Black's pawn on e5. Open files and minor-piece squares matter more than opposite-wing races.

Exchange Variation / compare decisions

11... H6 VERSUS NA6

Asks a bishop on g5 to choose a square and controls g5, at the cost of a potential pawn target.

Sample A: 11... h6 12. Bf4 Na6 13. Bf3 Nh7 14. Nd7

Sample B: 11... Na6 12. Rd6

13... NC5 VERSUS NXE4

Uses a central outpost to pressure e4 and nearby squares; check White's b4 advance.

Sample A: 13... Nc5 14. Bf3 g5 15. Bh2 Be6 16. b3

Sample B: 13... Nxe4 14. Nxe4

15... A5 VERSUS H5

Restrains b4 and can support a knight on c5.

Sample A: 15... a5

Sample B: 15... h5 16. b4 Ncd7 17. Nxd7 Nxd7 18. Kc2

17... A4 VERSUS RAD8

Improves the pawn on a4. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

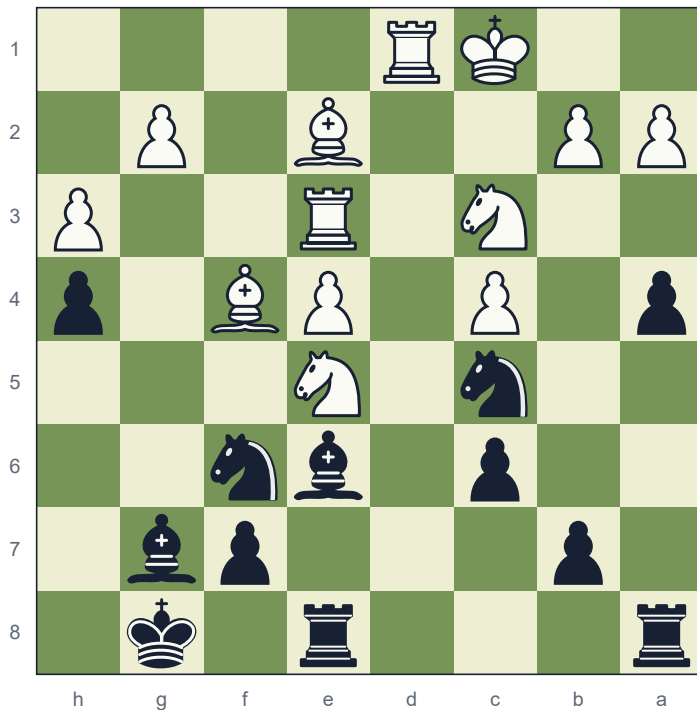
Sample A: 17... a4 18. Re3

Sample B: 17... Rad8 18. Rxd8 Rxd8 19. Rd1 Rxd1+ 20. Kxd1

The alternatives were searched at 500,000 nodes per analysis with MultiPV 2. A finite search is a comparison aid, not proof of a unique best move.

Exchange Variation / sample play

11... h6 12. Bf4 Na6 13. h3 Nc5 14. Bf3 g5 15. Bg3 a5 16. Rhe1 Be6 17. Bh2 a4 18. Re3 h5 19. Be2 h4 20. f4 gxf4 21. Bxf4



Black to move | sample endpoint

EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pieces were exchanged? Did a pawn contact disappear? Is the original plan still useful, or has an open file or king-safety issue become more urgent?

YOUR NEXT DECISION

Name two candidate moves for the side to move. Calculate the forcing reply to each, then explain Black's longer-term job from the resulting position.

REPLAY DRILL

Return to the start position and play against a partner or a program. Record your first divergence from the sample and one defensive resource you missed. Review the decision before asking the engine for a numerical evaluation.

Samisch / start

LAB 09-01 | Begin at 11... | Black to move



Black to move

YOUR INTENDED PLAN

Against long castling, examine ...b5 as an attack on the king. Against a slower setup, compare ...e5 and central piece development.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White may play Qd2, castle long and attack with h4, or choose a quieter king placement. White can also close with d5.

BEFORE TURNING THE PAGE

Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate the strongest forcing reply and identify the piece or pawn that changes its role. If the position is in check, begin with legal replies to that check.

STRUCTURE CHECKPOINT

White supports e4 with f3 and often leaves the king flexible. Black's c-pawn remains free, and the c6 knight pressures d4.

Samisch / compare decisions

11... A5 VERSUS RA8

Restrains b4 and can support a knight on c5.

Sample A: 11... a5

Sample B: 11... Ra8 12. Be2 a5 13. O-O-O a4 14. Na1

13... E6 VERSUS C6

Improves the pawn on e6. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 13... e6

Sample B: 13... c6 14. Nb3 b5 15. cxb5 cxb5 16. Nd4

15... C5 VERSUS C6

Challenges the d4 pawn from the side and creates a central contact that must be calculated.

Sample A: 15... c5 16. dxc6 bxc6 17. Nc4 Nxc4 18. Bxc4

Sample B: 15... c6 16. dxc6 bxc6 17. Nc4 Nxc4 18. Bxc4

17... NXC4 VERSUS NE8

The knight captures on c4. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan.

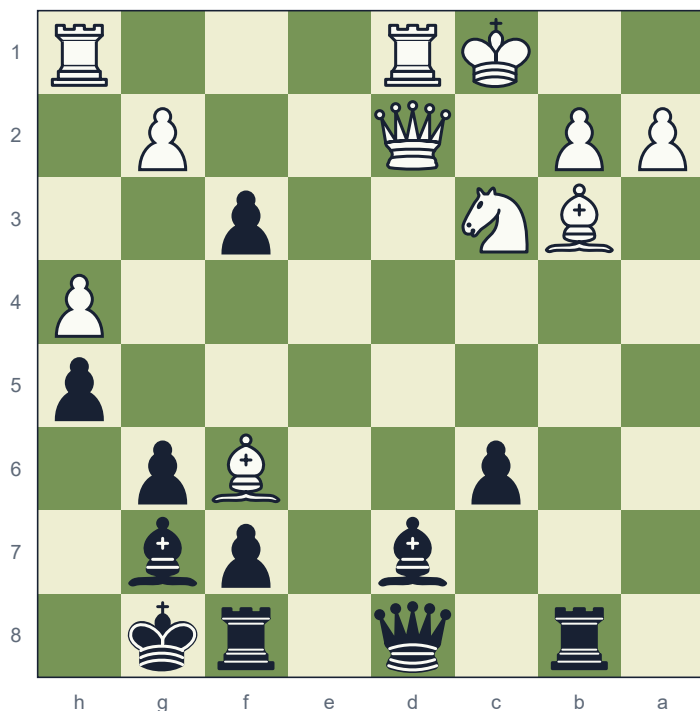
Sample A: 17... Nxc4 18. Bxc4 d5 19. Bb3 Rxb3 20. axb3

Sample B: 17... Ne8 18. Bh6 Be6 19. Bxg7 Nxc4 20. Bxc4

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Samisch / sample play

11... a5 12. d5 Ne5 13. Nxa5 e6 14. O-O-O exd5 15. cxd5 c5 16. dxc6 bxc6 17. Nc4 Nxc4 18. Bxc4 d5
19. Bb3 dxe4 20. Bg5 exf3 21. Bxf6



Black to move | sample endpoint

EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pieces were exchanged? Did a pawn contact disappear? Is the original plan still useful, or has an open file or king-safety issue become more urgent?

YOUR NEXT DECISION

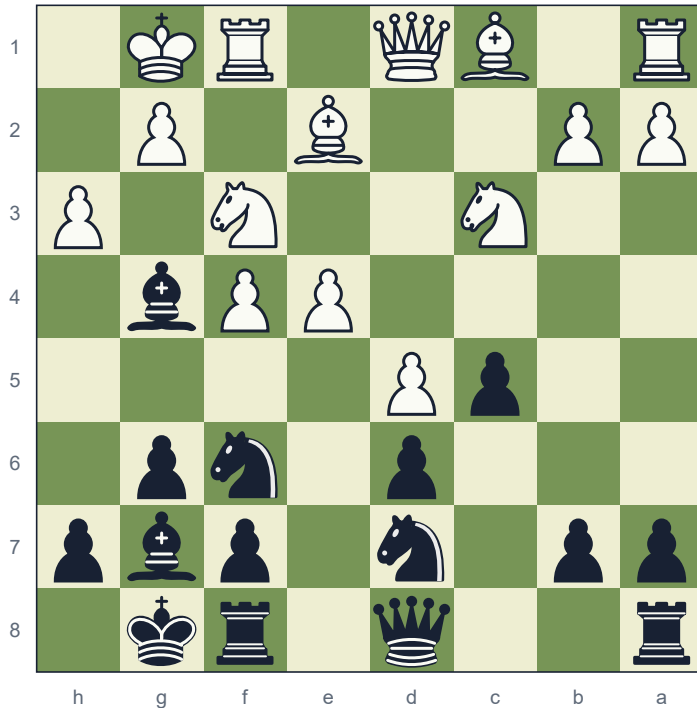
Name two candidate moves for the side to move. Calculate the forcing reply to each, then explain Black's longer-term job from the resulting position.

REPLAY DRILL

Return to the start position and play against a partner or a program. Record your first divergence from the sample and one defensive resource you missed. Review the decision before asking the engine for a numerical evaluation.

Four Pawns Attack / start

LAB 11-01 | Begin at 11... | Black to move



Black to move

YOUR INTENDED PLAN

Use ...Re8, ...a6 and sometimes ...b5 after completing development. Watch White's e5 advance on every move.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White wants e5 with tempo, a protected d5 wedge, and an attack supported by space. White may exchange into a central bind instead.

BEFORE TURNING THE PAGE

Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate the strongest forcing reply and identify the piece or pawn that changes its role. If the position is in check, begin with legal replies to that check.

STRUCTURE CHECKPOINT

White builds c4/d4/e4/f4. The pawn mass controls space but creates targets and leaves development unfinished.

Four Pawns Attack / compare decisions

11... Bxf3 VERSUS Bh5

The bishop captures on f3. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan.

Sample A: 11... Bxf3 12. Bxf3

Sample B: 11... Bh5 12. g4 Nxg4 13. hxg4 Bxg4 14. Ng5

13... H6 VERSUS B5

Asks a bishop on g5 to choose a square and controls g5, at the cost of a potential pawn target.

Sample A: 13... h6

Sample B: 13... b5 14. g5 Nh5 15. Ne2 c4 16. Be3

15... NH7 VERSUS DXE5

Improves the knight on h7. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 15... Nh7 16. e6 gxf4 17. exd7 Qxd7 18. Kg2

Sample B: 15... dxe5 16. fxg5 Nh7 17. Ne4 f5 18. gxf6

17... QXD7 VERSUS RE7

The queen captures on d7. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan.

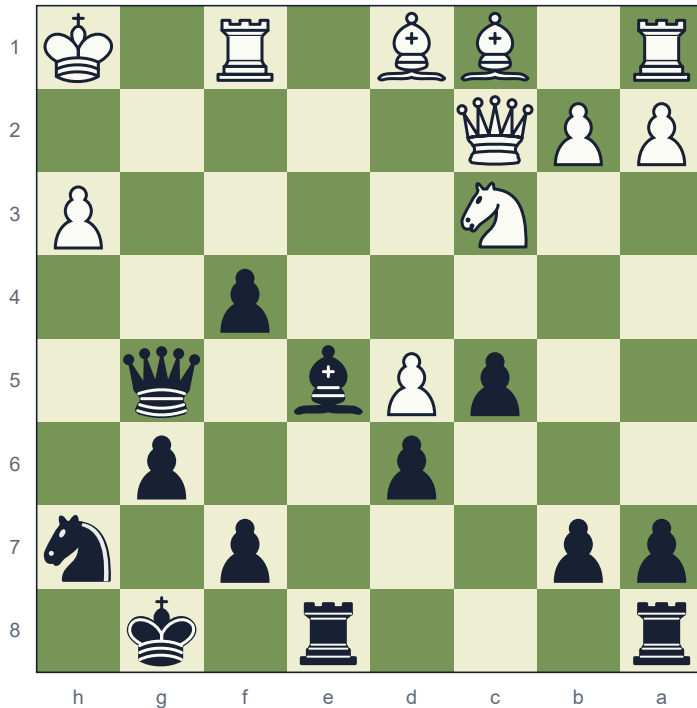
Sample A: 17... Qxd7

Sample B: 17... Re7 18. Bxf4 Qxd7 19. Kg2 Be5 20. Qd2

The alternatives were searched at 500,000 nodes per analysis with MultiPV 2. A finite search is a comparison aid, not proof of a unique best move.

Four Pawns Attack / sample play

11... Bxf3 12. Bxf3 Re8 13. g4 h6 14. g5 hxg5 15. e5 Nh7 16. e6 gxf4 17. exd7 Qxd7 18. Kg2 Be5 19. Qc2 Qd8 20. Bd1 Qg5+ 21. Kh1



Black to move | sample endpoint

EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pieces were exchanged? Did a pawn contact disappear? Is the original plan still useful, or has an open file or king-safety issue become more urgent?

YOUR NEXT DECISION

Name two candidate moves for the side to move. Calculate the forcing reply to each, then explain Black's longer-term job from the resulting position.

REPLAY DRILL

Return to the start position and play against a partner or a program. Record your first divergence from the sample and one defensive resource you missed. Review the decision before asking the engine for a numerical evaluation.

Averbakh / start

LAB 12-01 | Begin at 11... | Black to move



Black to move

YOUR INTENDED PLAN

Develop ...Re8, ...Nbd7 and the queen bishop actively. Inspect whether ...h6 wins a useful tempo or merely gives White an attacking target.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White wants to limit your kingside counterplay, support a broad center, and choose Nf3 or f4 later.

BEFORE TURNING THE PAGE

Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate the strongest forcing reply and identify the piece or pawn that changes its role. If the position is in check, begin with legal replies to that check.

STRUCTURE CHECKPOINT

The center often becomes a Benoni structure after d5 and ...exd5, with White's bishop already on g5.

Averbakh / compare decisions

11... NE4 VERSUS BC8

Improves the knight on e4. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 11... Ne4 12. Nxe4 Bxe4 13. f3 h6 14. Bxh6

Sample B: 11... Bc8 12. O-O Re8 13. Rfe1 Nbd7 14. h3

13... H6 VERSUS QXB2

Asks a bishop on g5 to choose a square and controls g5, at the cost of a potential pawn target.

Sample A: 13... h6 14. Bxh6 Bxh6 15. Qxh6 Qxb2 16. Rc1

Sample B: 13... Qxb2 14. Rc1 Qxd2+ 15. Kxd2 Bf5 16. Nxf5

15... QXB2 VERSUS BC2

The queen captures on b2. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan.

Sample A: 15... Qxb2

Sample B: 15... Bc2 16. Qc1 Qa5+ 17. Kf2 Qd8 18. g3

17... BC2 VERSUS BF5

Improves the bishop on c2. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

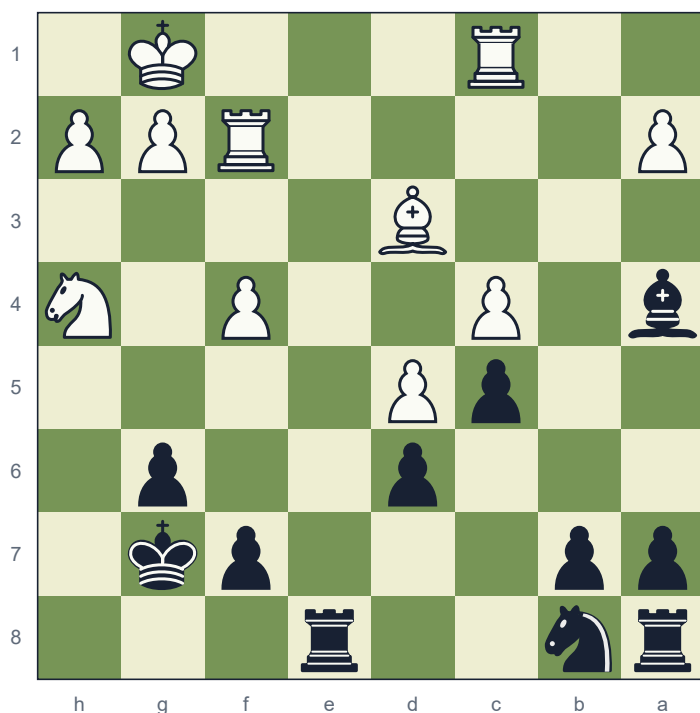
Sample A: 17... Bc2 18. Rf2 Ba4 19. Bf1 Qg7 20. Qg5

Sample B: 17... Bf5

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Averbakh / sample play

11... Ne4 12. Nxe4 Bxe4 13. f3 h6 14. Bxh6 Bxh6 15. Qxh6 Qxb2 16. Rc1 Re8 17. O-O Bc2 18. Rf2 Ba4 19. Bd3 Qg7 20. Qxg7+ Kxg7 21. f4



Black to move | sample endpoint

EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pieces were exchanged? Did a pawn contact disappear? Is the original plan still useful, or has an open file or king-safety issue become more urgent?

YOUR NEXT DECISION

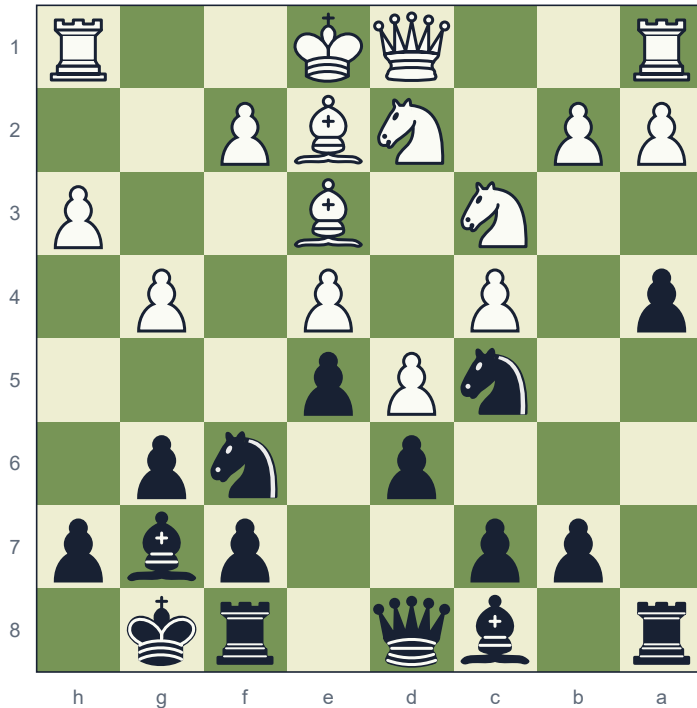
Name two candidate moves for the side to move. Calculate the forcing reply to each, then explain Black's longer-term job from the resulting position.

REPLAY DRILL

Return to the start position and play against a partner or a program. Record your first divergence from the sample and one defensive resource you missed. Review the decision before asking the engine for a numerical evaluation.

Makogonov and h3 systems / start

LAB 13-01 | Begin at 11... | Black to move



Black to move

YOUR INTENDED PLAN

Improve the queen bishop and prepare a central or kingside break with support. Keep the c5 knight from becoming a fixed target.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White wants d5, Be3 or Bg5, and sometimes g4. The delayed king choice makes your attacking direction less automatic.

BEFORE TURNING THE PAGE

Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate the strongest forcing reply and identify the piece or pawn that changes its role. If the position is in check, begin with legal replies to that check.

STRUCTURE CHECKPOINT

h3 keeps the g-pawn flexible and controls g4. White may keep the king in the center, castle short, or attack your king.

Makogonov and h3 systems / compare decisions

11... C6 VERSUS NE8

Controls d5 and can support a later ...d5 break or challenge a white d5 wedge.

Sample A: 11... c6

Sample B: 11... Ne8 12. h4 f5 13. g5 a3 14. b4

13... NH5 VERSUS NE8

Vacates f6 for the f-pawn and influences f4. Keep a safe route if White attacks the knight.

Sample A: 13... Nh5

Sample B: 13... Ne8 14. h4 f6 15. f3 Qa5 16. O-O-O

15... QA5 VERSUS KH8

Creates concrete pressure on central or queenside targets; count tempo attacks on the queen.

Sample A: 15... Qa5 16. Ke2 h4 17. b4 axb3 18. axb3

Sample B: 15... Kh8 16. Bxc5

17... AXB3 VERSUS QXB4

The immediate en passant capture changes the pawn contact and opens lines; check the resulting attacks.

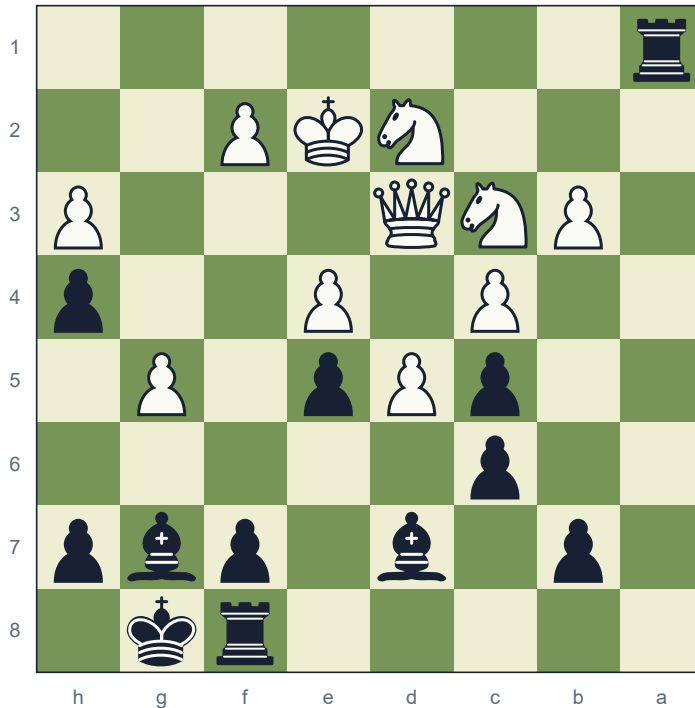
Sample A: 17... axb3 18. axb3

Sample B: 17... Qxb4 18. Rab1 Qa5 19. Bxc5 Qxc5 20. Nxa4

The alternatives were searched at 500,000 nodes per analysis with MultiPV 2. A finite search is a comparison aid, not proof of a unique best move.

Makogonov and h3 systems / sample play

11... c6 12. Qc2 Bd7 13. g5 Nh5 14. Bxh5 gxh5 15. Rg1 Qa5 16. Ke2 h4 17. b4 axb3 18. axb3 Qxa1 19. Rxa1 Rxa1 20. Bxc5 dxc5 21. Qd3



Black to move | sample endpoint

EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pieces were exchanged? Did a pawn contact disappear? Is the original plan still useful, or has an open file or king-safety issue become more urgent?

YOUR NEXT DECISION

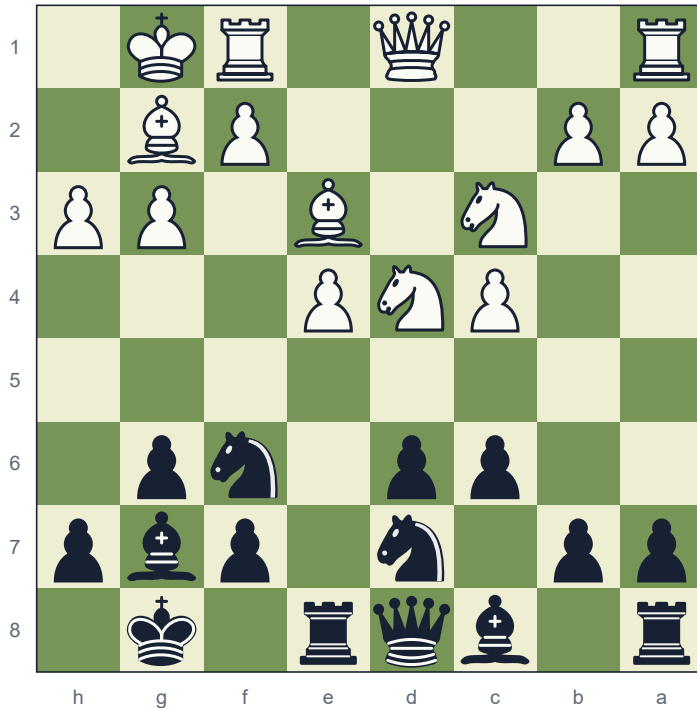
Name two candidate moves for the side to move. Calculate the forcing reply to each, then explain Black's longer-term job from the resulting position.

REPLAY DRILL

Return to the start position and play against a partner or a program. Record your first divergence from the sample and one defensive resource you missed. Review the decision before asking the engine for a numerical evaluation.

Fianchetto / start

LAB 14-01 | Begin at 11... | Black to move



Black to move

YOUR INTENDED PLAN

Compare ...exd4 followed by ...Nc5 with keeping the tension. Use ...a5 if it helps the knight or restrains b4.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White wants a safe king, strong central control, and pressure on the long diagonal. White often meets attacks by exchanging the center.

BEFORE TURNING THE PAGE

Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate the strongest forcing reply and identify the piece or pawn that changes its role. If the position is in check, begin with legal replies to that check.

STRUCTURE CHECKPOINT

The long diagonal is a major feature. The center may stay tense, close with d5, or open through ...exd4.

Fianchetto / compare decisions

11... A5 VERSUS NC5

Restrains b4 and can support a knight on c5.

Sample A: 11... a5 12. Qc2 a4 13. Rad1 Qa5 14. Rfe1

Sample B: 11... Nc5

13... NB6 VERSUS QE7

Improves the knight on b6. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 13... Nb6 14. c5 Nc4 15. Bc1 a3 16. b3

Sample B: 13... Qe7 14. Re1

15... NB6 VERSUS QE7

Improves the knight on b6. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 15... Nb6

Sample B: 15... Qe7 16. Re1 Nc5 17. Rad1 Qc7 18. f4

17... QE7 VERSUS RA6

Improves the queen on e7. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

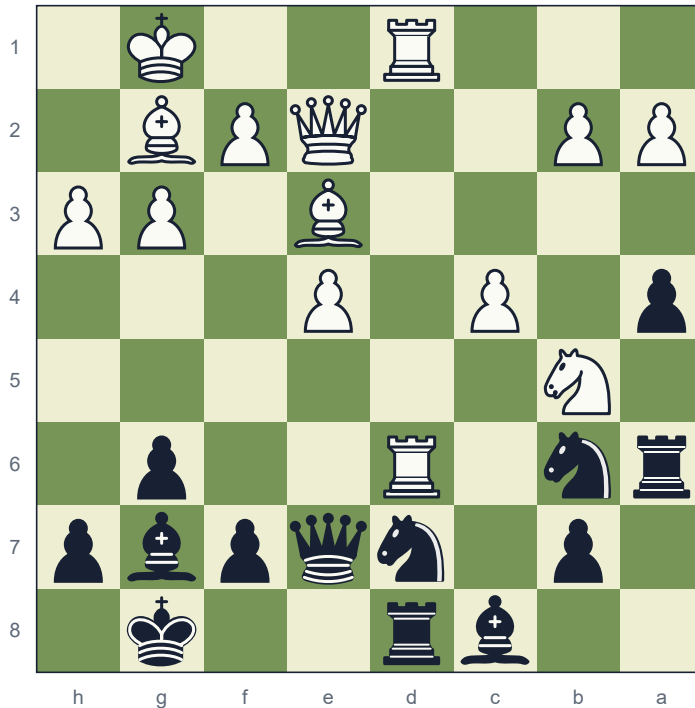
Sample A: 17... Qe7 18. Re1 Nc5 19. Rbd1 Qf8 20. b3

Sample B: 17... Ra6

The alternatives were searched at 500,000 nodes per analysis with MultiPV 2. A finite search is a comparison aid, not proof of a unique best move.

Fianchetto / sample play

11... a5 12. Qc2 a4 13. Rfd1 Nb6 14. Bf1 Nbd7 15. Bg2 Nb6 16. Qe2 Nfd7 17. Rab1 Qe7 18. Ndb5 cxb5
19. Nxb5 Rd8 20. Rxd6 Ra6 21. Rbd1



Black to move | sample endpoint

EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pieces were exchanged? Did a pawn contact disappear? Is the original plan still useful, or has an open file or king-safety issue become more urgent?

YOUR NEXT DECISION

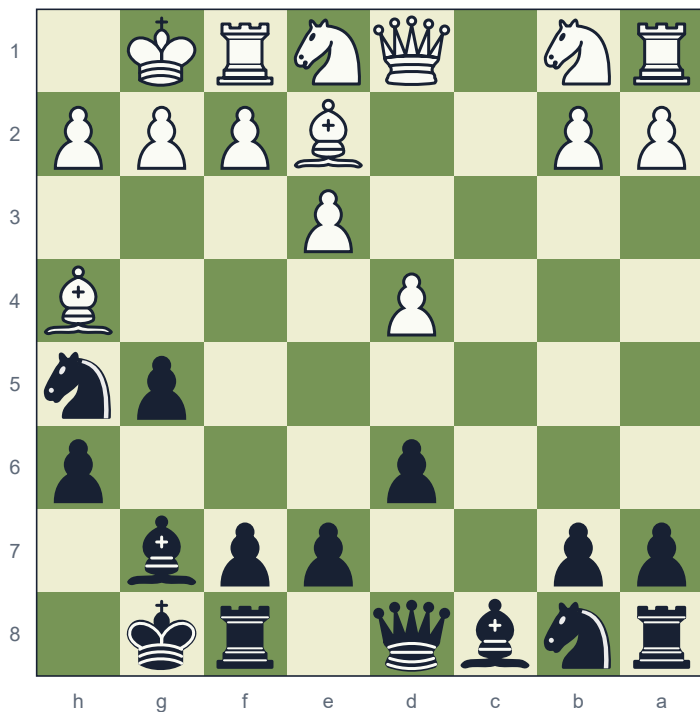
Name two candidate moves for the side to move. Calculate the forcing reply to each, then explain Black's longer-term job from the resulting position.

REPLAY DRILL

Return to the start position and play against a partner or a program. Record your first divergence from the sample and one defensive resource you missed. Review the decision before asking the engine for a numerical evaluation.

London Torre and Colle / start

LAB 19-01 | Begin at 11... | Black to move



Black to move

YOUR INTENDED PLAN

Develop ...Nc6 and pressure d4. Keep d6 defended against Bf4 and look for an active queen square.

WHITE'S RESOURCES

White wants a stable setup and often an e4 break. Bf4 can attack d6; Bg5 can pin Nf6.

BEFORE TURNING THE PAGE

Write two candidate moves. For each, calculate the strongest forcing reply and identify the piece or pawn that changes its role. If the position is in check, begin with legal replies to that check.

STRUCTURE CHECKPOINT

Without c4 and e4 together, White has a smaller center and different bishop activity. The dark-squared bishop may develop outside the pawn chain.

London Torre and Colle / compare decisions

11... GXH4 VERSUS NF4

The pawn captures on h4. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan.

Sample A: 11... gxh4 12. Bxh5 e5 13. dxe5 dxe5 14. Nc3

Sample B: 11... Nf4 12. exf4

13... DXE5 VERSUS ND7

The pawn captures on e5. Follow the recapture and reassess the pawn structure before continuing the plan.

Sample A: 13... dxe5 14. Nc3 Nd7 15. Bg4 Nc5 16. Bxc8

Sample B: 13... Nd7 14. Nc3 dxe5 15. Be2 h3 16. Bg4

15... NB6 VERSUS NF6

Improves the knight on b6. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

Sample A: 15... Nb6

Sample B: 15... Nf6 16. h3 e4 17. Nxe4 Nxe4 18. Bxe4

17... QE7 VERSUS RB8

Improves the queen on e7. Connect the move to the center and the opponent's immediate threat.

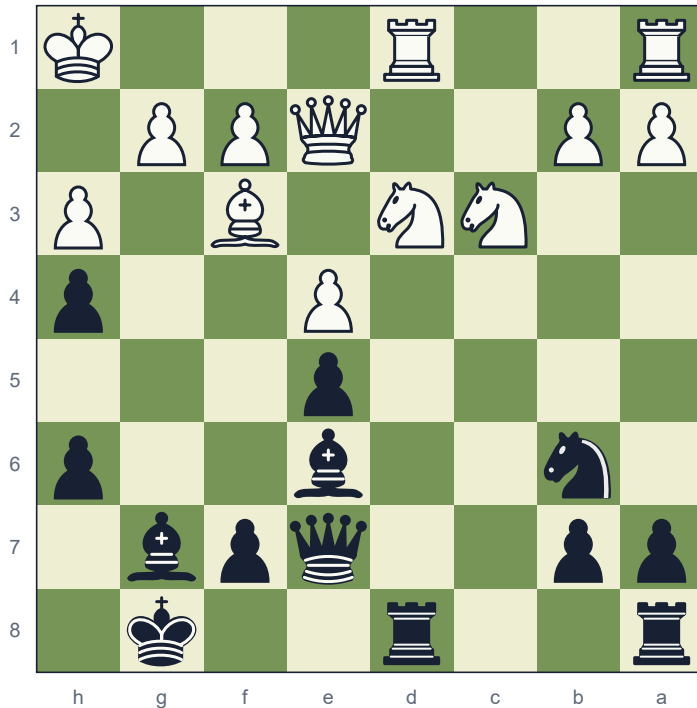
Sample A: 17... Qe7 18. Nd5 Nxd5 19. Bxd5 e4 20. Nc2

Sample B: 17... Rb8 18. Qe2

The alternatives were searched at 500,000 nodes per analysis with MultiPV 2. A finite search is a comparison aid, not proof of a unique best move.

London Torre and Colle / sample play

11... gxf4 12. Bxf4 e5 13. dxe5 dxe5 14. Nc3 Nd7 15. Bf3 Nb6 16. h3 Qg5 17. Kh1 Qe7 18. Nd3 Rd8 19. Qe2 Bf5 20. e4 Be6 21. Rfd1



Black to move | sample endpoint

EXPLAIN THE CHANGES

Which pieces were exchanged? Did a pawn contact disappear? Is the original plan still useful, or has an open file or king-safety issue become more urgent?

YOUR NEXT DECISION

Name two candidate moves for the side to move. Calculate the forcing reply to each, then explain Black's longer-term job from the resulting position.

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